



New Zealand Service Offering

ABN: 12 689 510 754

Marketplace Registration: TBC

October 2026

Executive Summary

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2	Standards-based expertise We work to ISO, OpenID and W3C standards, and led Australia’s first ISO-standard wallet and NZ’s Trust Framework.	3–4
3	Support across the full lifecycle Five service stages, from workshops and governance through design, procurement, launch and continuous improvement.	5–11
4	Use Case: Trust Framework Reference Architecture We led the co-design of the DISTF Reference Architecture with over 40 public and private sector organisations.	10
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7	Senior team with a local base Led by Chris Goh and James Little, with people in Auckland and Wellington and a wider team in Australia.	14

Why Us?

Trusted Advisors to Government

We have worked at the heart of government on digital identity, from policy development and legislation through to ministerial advice and delivery. We understand how decisions get made, what ministers and boards need to see, and how to build the authorising environment that lets significant change happen across agencies and sectors.

From Start to Finish

We support organisations across the full lifecycle, from initial exploration and use case development through business cases, design, procurement, accreditation, and launch. Clients get a single advisory partner who understands how early decisions play out in delivery, and who stays involved to make sure benefits are realised.

Frameworks, Accreditations, Guardrails

For over a decade we have advised on national identity and accreditation frameworks that provide guardrails for trust and interoperability. We help organisations navigate regulatory requirements, prepare for accreditation, and align with standards that support mutual recognition across jurisdictions and industries.

Deep Understanding of Digital Identity

We understand decentralised digital identity, verifiable credentials, and digital wallets, and participate in the international standards that underpin them. Our work centres on the ISO mobile document standards (ISO/IEC 18013-5 and 23220), OpenID protocols (OID4VCI and OID4VP) and the W3C Digital Credentials API. We help organisations to meet local accreditation requirements, align with New Zealand's digital public infrastructure, and remain interoperable internationally.

From Legacy to Verifiable Credentials

Moving from centralised and federated identity models to verifiable credentials is as much an organisational shift as a technical one. We help organisations manage the transition, bridging existing systems with new capabilities and bringing their people, processes, and partners with them.

Global Experience, Local Base

We've worked with governments and industry across the globe and contribute to the international forums shaping digital identity. With key personnel in Auckland and Wellington, supported by our team in Australia, we combine global perspective with first-hand knowledge of New Zealand.



About Valid8

We are a specialized advisory firm focused on enabling organisations and public services to deliver meaningful digital service and economic reform. While many advisors stop at strategy documents, our point of difference is execution. We partner with clients to implement customer-led approaches that deliver real outcomes across diverse stakeholder environments, whether navigating complex regulatory constraints or operating without established legislative frameworks.

We know the complexities of Digital Identity and Verifiable Credentials

Our deep understanding of Digital Identity and Verifiable Credentials stems from direct involvement in national policy development, ISO-standards implementation, international trust framework design, and cross-jurisdictional interoperability initiatives. We have navigated the technical, regulatory, and stakeholder coordination challenges that define successful digital identity adoption. This includes leading Australia's first digital wallet rollout to assessing ecosystem readiness across Europe and the United States. This practical experience equips us to evaluate the diverse maturity levels and institutional contexts across jurisdictions allowing us to tailor solutions and strategies while enabling international interoperability.

Our core capabilities

Our team meets your required qualifications for this engagement as highlighted in the previous page.



Government advisory experience: Over seven years advising and leading governments on digital identity, including co-chairing Australia's National Verifiable Credentials Working Group, leading New Zealand's Digital Identity Services Trust Framework, and advising across Europe and Asia



Multi-country/regional management: Conducted global VC assessments across Europe and the United States and led national initiatives across jurisdictions.



Multidisciplinary policy research: Delivered Queensland's State ICT Maturity Assessment and hosted four international summits coordinating multi-stakeholder consultations on VC interoperability.



Digital identity and infrastructure expertise: International expert in digital identity and VCs since 2018, led Australia's first ISO-standards digital wallet rollout, and the implementation of New Zealand's Digital Identity Services Trust Framework



Political Economy Understanding: Developed national cross-border VC architecture for government, banks, and community services, navigating complex institutional stakeholder environments.



Analytical & Communication Capacity: Synthesised complex findings into whole-of-government investment strategies and national digital identity adoption priorities for stakeholders.



Multilingual Operational Capacity: International engagement across Europe demonstrates cross-cultural coordination capability.

1. Introduction, Assessment, Workshops, and Demos



How we help

Valid8 Advisory helps organisations understand what digital identity and verifiable credentials can do for them, and where they fit in New Zealand's regulatory and technical landscape. Through facilitated workshops with leadership and delivery teams, we identify practical use cases, test assumptions about customer and business needs, and establish a shared understanding of the opportunity. The result is a clear scoping report and proposal that gives decision-makers a sound basis to make strategic decisions on how to proceed.

What's included



Introduction to digital identity and verifiable credentials



Use case identification and development



Exploration of business and customer expectations



Initial scoping reports and proposals



End-to-end technical demonstration



Overview of New Zealand and international digital identity context

How we help

Digital identity initiatives cut across technology, policy, legal, and customer functions, and they need governance that reflects that. **Valid8 Advisory** helps organisations set strategic direction, establish governance arrangements and decision rights, and secure the authorising environment needed to move forward. We develop business cases and benefits plans that stand up to scrutiny from boards, ministers, and investment panels, and programme plans that anticipate the change the initiative will demand.

What's included

 Strategic planning

 Governance design and authorising environment

 Programme and change management planning

 Business case and benefits planning



Recent Media Commentary

"New Zealand's not only getting innovation from the government sector, you're getting innovation from the private sector. Your legislation and regulations are designed for inclusion, and that co-design process I was part of... you really have to lift your hat to the New Zealand Government for bringing in industry and the community."



Chris Goh, *Nine to Noon*, 9 September 2026

"The work we're doing on digital identity is about taking those documents you might already have, or that would be useful, and giving them to you on a wallet on your phone so you can use them in person or online [...] when I say, would it be useful if you had your driver's licence or your passport on your phone, [people] say, 'Sign me up immediately'"



James Little, *OK computer: The coming revolution in digital IDs*
29 August 2026

[Chris] Goh described the cryptography used in the system as "military-grade", and said it was endorsed by NATO, the European Union, and US Homeland Security.

"The cryptography is actually much stronger than your credit card in some ways as well"



Chris Goh, *Digital driver's licences: Will hackers and government be able to track you?*
19 September 2026





How we help

Digital identity services must be designed to meet the requirements of the people who will use them and the law that governs them. **Valid8 Advisory** brings together customer-centred design, architecture that aligns with international standards, and a detailed understanding of New Zealand's legislative and regulatory settings, including the Digital Identity Services Trust Framework Act 2023, the Privacy Act 2020, and the New Zealand Identification Standards. We help organisations shape commercial and operating models that are sustainable, and assess whether the market is ready to deliver what they need.

What's included



Co-design with customers and stakeholders



Customer experience design



System design and architecture



Legislation, regulation, and policy frameworks



Market readiness and procurement planning



Commercial and operating models

How we help

Valid8 Advisory supports organisations to find and secure the right partners, from understanding who is active in the market through to structuring tenders and negotiating terms. We draw on our knowledge of the New Zealand and Australian digital identity markets to help clients assess vendor capability from the global marketplace, consider partnership and shared-service models, and plan how the service will be managed once it's live.

What's included



Market scan and tender



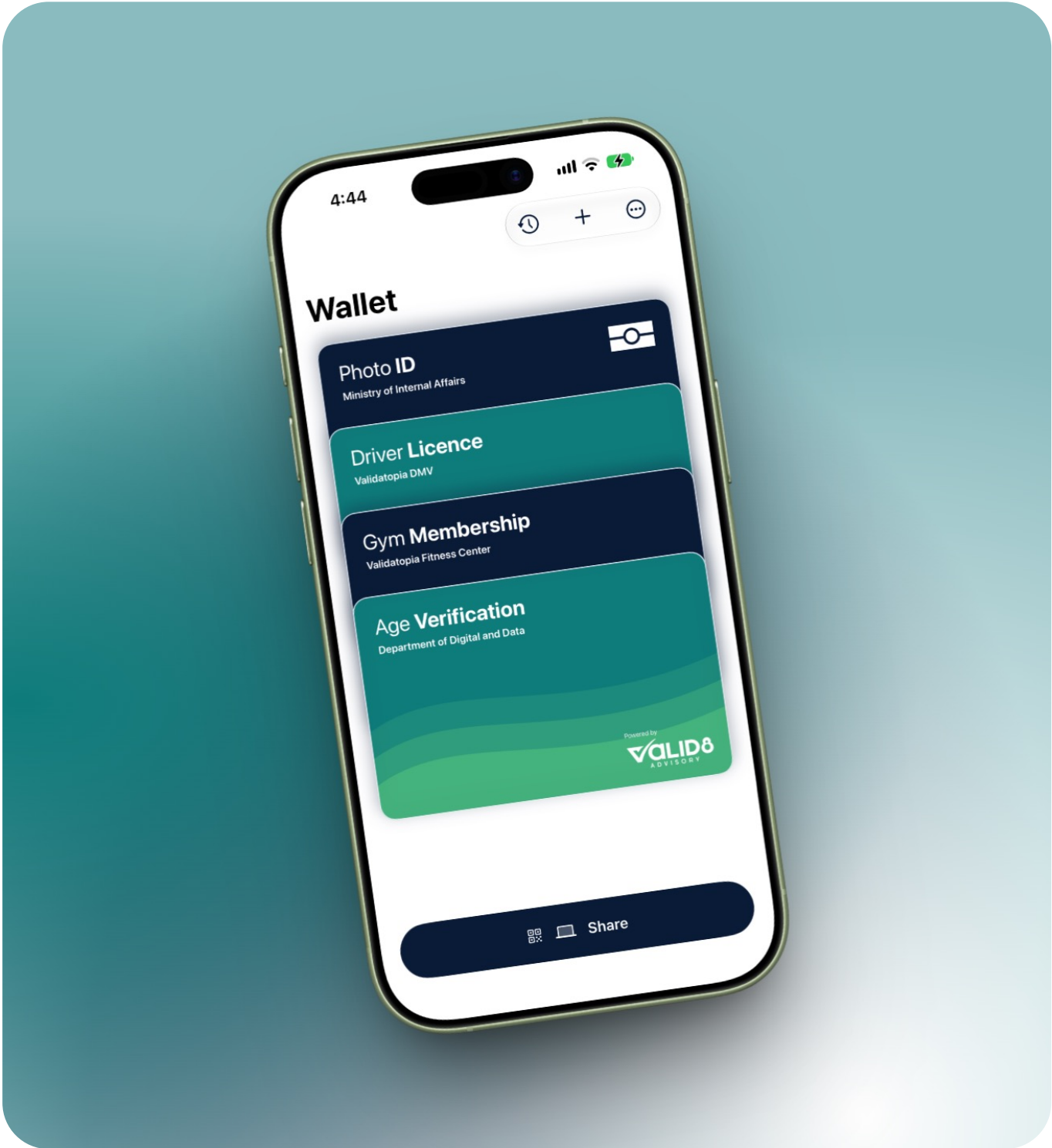
Joint partnership models



Procurement and negotiation approach



Service management planning



Use Case



**Government Digital
Delivery Agency**
Te Pūnaha Matihiko

Trust Framework Reference Architecture

Commissioned by the Government Digital Delivery Agency (then the Department of Internal Affairs), **Valid8 Advisory** led the co-design, drafting and consultation of the Digital Identity Services Trust Framework Reference Architecture, a practical blueprint for putting the Digital Identity Services Trust Framework Act 2023 into operation.

The co-design process involved over 40 organisations across the public and private sectors through regular workshops held in person and online, whiteboard sessions, draft review and consultation, and collective contribution and endorsement.

The publicly available document defines the roles, trust model, assurance levels, data model and standards needed to issue, hold and present¹⁰ digital identity credentials securely, with accessibility, inclusion and privacy built in. It aligns with international standards and practice (ISO, W3C, IETF, OpenID and the EU) to support cross-border interoperability.

The reference architecture comprises nine chapters, annexes and supporting implementation guidance. It is the common reference point for everyone building digital identity services in Aotearoa New Zealand.

<https://github.com/nz-trust-framework/DISTF-reference-architecture>

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New Zealand Digital Identity Services Trust Framework



The [Digital Identity Services Trust Framework Act 2023](#) establishes the legislative framework for "the provision of secure and trusted digital identity services for individuals and organisations" in Aotearoa New Zealand.

While the legislation, along with its associated regulations and rules, establishes the legal foundation, clear guidance is still needed to define the architectural, business, and technological processes that will enable both regulated and unregulated participants, from the public and private sectors, to engage and jointly develop the kind of ecosystem the legislation envisions.

A Reference Architecture

This reference architecture sets out the practical blueprint for operating a secure, trusted, and interoperable digital identity ecosystem in Aotearoa New Zealand under the Digital Identity Services Trust Framework Act 2023.

Building on proven models from the European Union and other jurisdictions, it translates legislative requirements into clear technical and operational guidance for all ecosystem participants, across both public and private sectors.

It defines the architecture, roles, data flows, trust mechanisms, and standards needed to issue, store, and present digital identity credentials, while aligning with global best practice to support cross-border interoperability.

Developed through consultation with industry, government, and international partners, the reference architecture aims to provide a consensus-backed, technology-agnostic framework that gives implementers flexibility while ensuring compliance, consistency, and user-centric design.

The goal is to give all participants confidence in New Zealand's digital identity ecosystem and to provide users with seamless use of trusted services at home and abroad.



How we help

Trust in a digital identity service depends on it being secure, compliant, and well supported from the moment it goes live. **Valid8 Advisory** helps organisations plan and oversee a testing regime proportionate to the risk, prepare their security and policy settings for regulatory scrutiny, and give decision-makers assurance that the service and its stakeholders are ready. We support the change and communications work that launch demands, and stay involved beyond go-live to track benefits against the investment case and drive continuous improvement.

What's included



Planning and oversight of security, system, and user acceptance testing, including penetration testing and bug bounty programmes



Information Security Management System (ISMS), policy, and regulatory readiness



Readiness assurance ahead of go-live



Community, industry, and legislative change management



Communications and media planning



Service launch and transition to full service management



Benefits realisation, return on investment, and continuous improvement

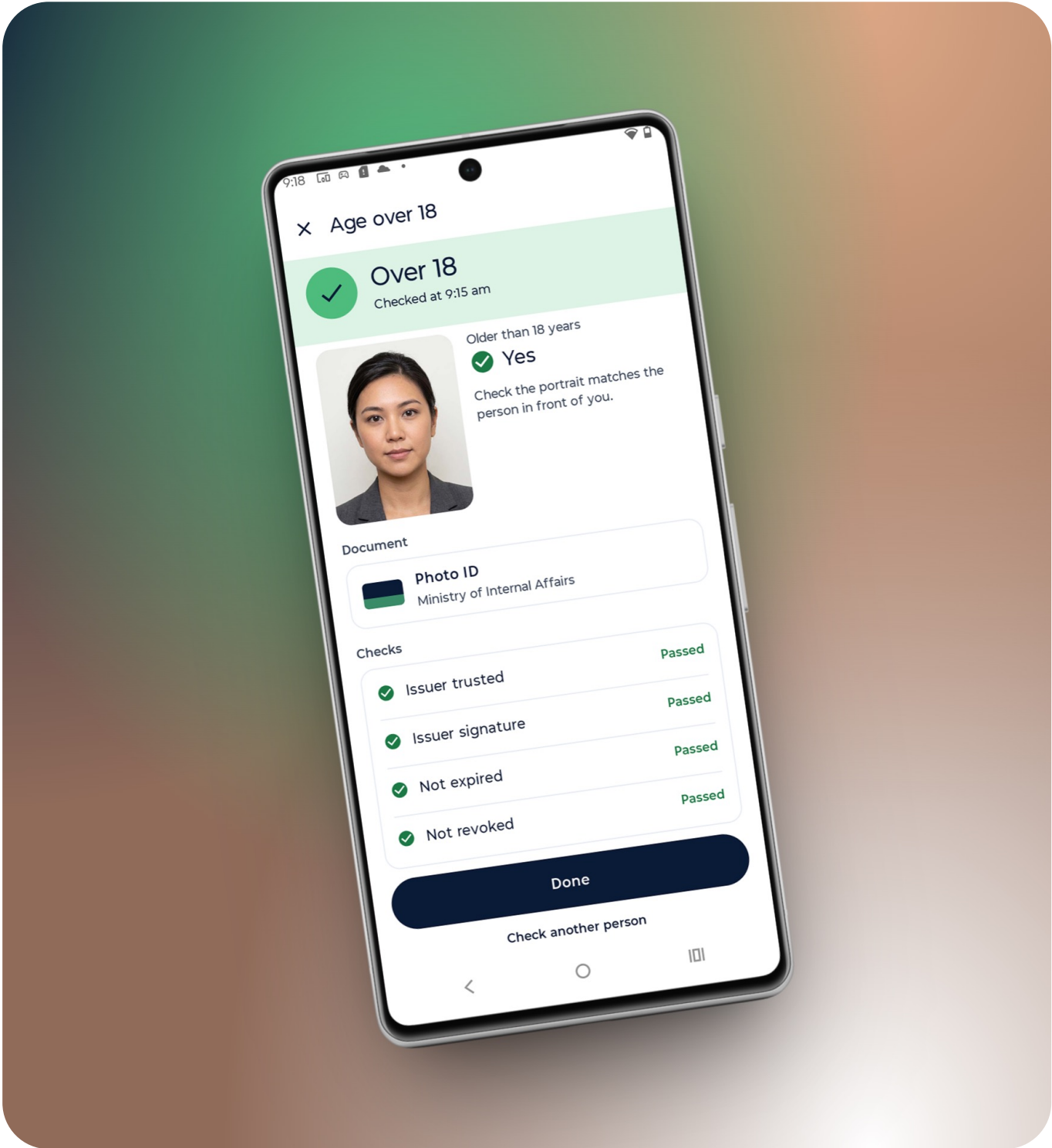
6. Trust Framework Accreditation

How we help

Accreditation under the Digital Identity Services Trust Framework demonstrates that a provider's services meet New Zealand's requirements for identification management, privacy, and security. **Valid8 Advisory** helps organisations assess their readiness, define which services to accredit, and prepare the documentation and evidence the Trust Framework Authority expects. We can co-ordinate the independent identification management, privacy, and security evaluations, compile the application, and manage engagement with the regulator through to a decision. This includes agencies issuing credentials through the all-of-government issuance platform.

What's included

 Maturity and readiness assessment	 Service definition and scoping
 Independent evaluator strategy, procurement, and co-ordination	 Identification management support
 Privacy and security support	 Provider and governance requirements support
 Application compilation and regulator engagement	 Support alignment with government digital public infrastructure



Example Work Plan: Digital Identity Service



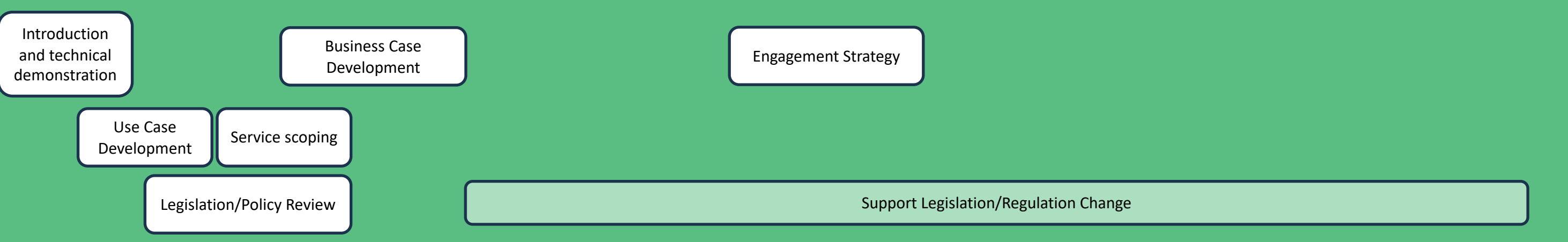
WEEKS

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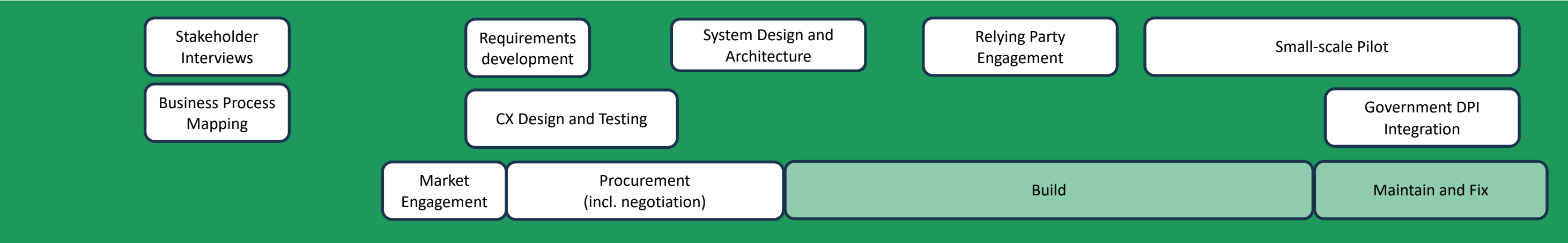
Governance & Approvals



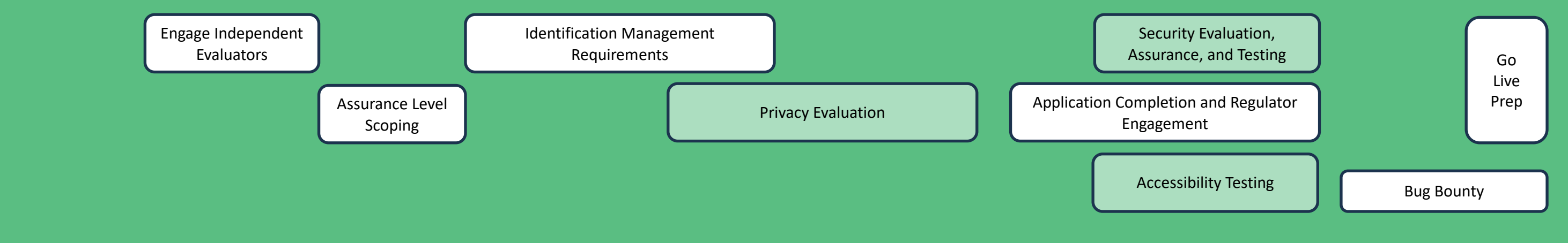
Analysis and Planning



Engage, Partner and Procure



Assurance and Accreditation



Our Team



Chris Goh

Valid8 Founder and Director

Public Servant for 30 years now Founder
Legislative, Architectural, CX Specialist

Chris is an experienced Executive and digital identity specialist with more than a decade of senior executive engagement across government, industry and regional bodies on digital transformation and cross-border digital policy and legislation.

- Standards expert in Verifiable Credentials (VCs)
- Established National Harmonization of VC's in Australia
- Recently worked with the European Commission to support their first EUDI Wallet Launch an testing
- Supporting New Zealand in the cross industry co-design of their Identity and VC architecture
- Implemented the first ISO compliant Digital Wallet in Queensland that has won a number of national accolades for inclusion, accessibility and customer design
- Co-chaired national working groups on VCs and assisted in developing State and National legislation and policy in the use and adoption of Verifiable Credentials

James Little

New Zealand Lead

Senior Government Adviser for a decade
Policy, Legislative, Regulatory Specialist

James has spent a decade advising at the most senior levels of the New Zealand Government on digital government and digital identity. He excels where clear direction is needed between competing policy, political and technical realities.

- Advised former PM and senior ministers on digital policy for six years
- Led development of the Digital Identity Services Trust Framework and the regulatory regime under which the first services were accredited
- Key role building New Zealand's digital identity infrastructure and modernising regulation across government
- Engages governments and speaks at conferences across Asia and Australia
- Deep grasp of digital strategy, policy and legislative design, and of verifiable credentials technology and standards
- Contributing author on DISTF Reference Architecture with deep knowledge on ISO 18013-5/23220 standards and implementation



Chris and James are supported by a wider team based across New Zealand and Australia

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